

Manual for FSPS v4.0

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1. Overview

The collection of fortran routines contained in this package allows the user to compute simple stellar populations (SSPs) for a variety of IMFs and metallicities, and for a variety of assumptions regarding the morphology of the horizontal branch, the blue straggler population, the post-AGB phase, and the location in the HR diagram of the TP-AGB phase. A variety of simple and flexible prescriptions for attenuation by dust are also included, as are dust emission models from diffuse dust and an AGN torus. From these SSPs the user may then generate composite stellar populations (CSPs) for a variety of star formation histories (SFHs) and dust attenuation prescriptions. Outputs include the spectra and magnitudes of the SSPs and CSPs at arbitrary redshift. In addition to these fortran routines a collection of IDL routines are provided that allow easy manipulation of the output.

The user is strongly encouraged to read Conroy et al. (2009) for an overview of stellar population synthesis (SPS) and for details regarding this collection of routines. This code has been extensively calibrated against a suite of observational data (for details see Conroy & Gunn 2010; Johnson et al. 2021; Park et al. 2025). The code package is in essence a highly flexible SPS code and has therefore come to be called FSPS.

The rest of this manual is organized as follows. In §1 we briefly discuss the overall philosophy of the code structure and highlight the main features. In §2 we present the routines, how they are used, and provide the user with a basic program that demonstrates the use of the routines. §3 discusses the IDL routines provided to read and manipulate the outputs from the fortran package. §4 discusses a variety of questions (ok, only one) the user may have.

For a description of revisions since the initial release of the code, see the file `REVISION_HISTORY` in the `doc` directory. Installation instructions are also provided in that directory.

1.1 Downloading the code

FSPS is distributed via github: github.com/cconroy20/fsp. The code can be checked out with standard github commands. Emails will be sent to the mailing list whenever new versions become available (this is one reason why it is essential for users of this code to be on the mailing list).

1.2 Environment variables

As mentioned on the webpage, you will need to set an environment variable called `SPS_HOME` that points to the root SPS directory (i.e. the directory that contains the `src`, `OUTPUTS`, etc. directories)

1.3 Inclusion of TP-AGB spectra

The TP-AGB empirical spectral library does not extend past the rest-frame K-band and so in previous versions the integrated spectra were not reliable beyond $\lambda \approx 2.4\mu\text{m}$. The TP-AGB spectra are extrapolated blueward with simpler linear slopes (as advocated in Lancon & Wood 2002). The spectra of the carbon stars are now extrapolated redward with the Aringer et al. (2009) synthetic carbon star spectral library. The spectra of the oxygen-rich TP-AGB stars are now extrapolated with the latest version of the PHOENIX stellar spectral library (the BT-SETTL library).

1.4 Units

This code produces two types of files. The first are spectral files (`*.spec`). The spectra are in units of $L_{\odot}/\text{Hz}$, i.e. they are f_{ν} . Integrating over frequency generates the bolometric luminosity of the spectrum. Wavelengths are in angstroms *in vacuum*, and the wavelength array for the stellar libraries can be found in the files `C3K/c3k.lrlambda` and `MILES/mileslambda`. The full wavelength array is also now printed in the first line in the `*.spec` files. The spectral resolution of the library is given in km/s dispersion in the e.g. `C3K/c3k.hr.res` files; negative numbers indicate approximate values since the spectrum comes from a model based on opacity binning. The second type of file contains magnitudes in a variety of filters. The magnitude zero point (i.e., AB or Vega) is set by the variable `compute_vega_mags` described below. Both of

these output files contain information on the age, mass, bolometric luminosity, and star formation rate. All of these quantities are in the log (base-10), with units of years, $M_{\odot}$, $L_{\odot}$, and $M_{\odot} \text{ yr}^{-1}$, respectively.

1.5 Redshift Effects

The code allows the user to specify a redshift (see Section 3.1.2 below). Specifying a non-zero redshift affects *both* the computed magnitudes and spectra. There are two qualitatively different options for redshifting. See the parameter `redshift_colors` below for more details. The returned magnitudes include both the relevant $(1+z)$ factors and the distance modulus. Also as of v2.5, IGM absorption via Madau (1995) can be turned on and will attenuate the spectrum (and mags). This feature is enabled only for non-zero redshifts.

1.6 Filters

The current release contains 159 filters. The filter names can be found in the file `FILTER_LIST` in the `data` directory. The actual filter definitions are in the file `allfilters.dat` in the same directory. The transmission profiles in this file include atmospheric absorption and are in units of relative response per photon (as opposed for example to relative response per unit power). The filters are normalized internally within the code. The output magnitudes are listed in the filter order displayed in the `FILTER_LIST` file. The user is cautioned to use whenever possible the exact filter transmission curve appropriate for the data being considered. There is, for example, no such thing as THE B -band filter. Differences of a few hundredths of a magnitude are common between different definitions of a given filter such as B .

1.7 Computation of magnitudes

The AB magnitude through a filter b , m_b , is defined according to the following formulae:

$$\langle f_{\nu} \rangle_b = \frac{\int R_{\gamma}^b f_{\nu} d \ln \nu}{\int (\nu/\nu_b)^{\beta} R_{\gamma}^b d \ln \nu} \quad (1)$$

$$m_b = -2.5 \log_{10}(\langle f_{\nu} \rangle_b) - 48.60 \quad (2)$$

where f_{ν} is the spectrum and R_{γ}^b is the relative response per photon of the filter. The factor $(\nu/\nu_b)^{\beta}$ in the denominator of Equation 1 may surprise those used to working with optical photometry. Indeed, for UV, optical, and near-IR photometry, one usually adopts $\beta = 0$ (e.g., for the GALEX, SDSS, and 2MASS surveys). However, IR photometry typically assumes a different calibration. For example, the *IRAS*, *Spitzer* IRAC, and *Herschel* PACS and SPIRE magnitudes are frequently quoted assuming $\beta = 1$ while the *Spitzer* MIPS filters adopt $\beta = 2$ (i.e., a 10^4 K blackbody). The parameter ν_b is the central wavelength of the filter.

The motivation underlying this convention is that for sources with an intrinsic spectral slope β , the bandpass-convolved flux quoted at frequency ν_b will be precisely the flux at that frequency. For example, observing a 10^4 K blackbody through the MIPS filters with the above calibration will return a flux density at the central frequency of the filter that is precisely the true flux at ν_b . In the end, this is merely a convention, but one that must be handled carefully when comparing data to models. See the routine `sps_setup.f90` for implementation.

1.8 Interpretation of the Δ_L and Δ_T parameters

As described below, when using the Padova isochrones, the user may modify the bolometric luminosity and effective temperature of the TP-AGB phase by applying overall shifts in $\log(L_{\text{bol}})$ and $\log(T_{\text{eff}})$ via the parameters Δ_L and Δ_T . These parameters represent shifts with respect to the best-fit values found in Villaume et al. (2015).

1.9 Dust attenuation models

The philosophy of the primary dust absorption model closely follows the two component model of Charlot & Fall (2000). In the general case there is dust associated with young stars (where the definition of young is defined by the parameter `dust_tesc`) with an optical depth `dust1` and a power-law attenuation curve with index `dust1_index`. There is a second dust component affecting all stars equally and is implemented as a uniform screen. This component has an optical depth `dust2` and an attenuation curve specified by the parameter `dust_type`. An optional third component with optical depth `dust3` that only affects the older

stars can also be included. Currently supported attenuation models include a power-law curve with index `dust_index`, a Milky-Way-like curve (following CCM89 but with a variable UV bump strength), a Calzetti et al. (2000) curve, models from Witt & Gordon (2000) and Gordon et al. (2003) and the parameterized models from Kriek & Conroy (2013) and Reddy et al. (2015). Note that one can specify an effective uniform screen (as commonly employed when implementing the Calzetti curve, although technically one should not think of the Calzetti law as representing a uniform screen) by setting `dust1= 0.0`.

1.10 Dust emission model

FSPS includes two models for dust emission (see the parameter `add_dust_emission` below) – the Draine & Li 2007 model (DL07) and the THEMIS model (Jones et al. 2013, 2017). Since there is currently no publication discussing this aspect of FSPS, a few words regarding the details and implementation of the dust emission model are in order.

The Draine & Li (2007; DL07) is a silicate-graphite-PAH grain model. The model produces dust emission spectra from $1 - 10^4 \mu m$ as a function of the interstellar radiation field, U , expressed in units of the Milky Way radiation field. DL07 advocate constructing spectra for entire galaxies by summing up emission spectra over a range of radiation field strengths, $P(U)dU$ approximated by a delta function at $U_{\min}$ and a power-law component from $U_{\min} < U \leq U_{\max}$. As suggested by DL07, we have fixed $U_{\max} = 10^6$ and the power-law slope to be $\alpha = 2.0$. We therefore have: $P(U)dU = (1 - \gamma)\delta(U - U_{\min}) + \gamma AU^{-2}$, where $(1 - \gamma)$ is the fraction of dust mass exposed to starlight intensity $U_{\min}$ and A is a normalization constant. The DL07 model thus has three parameters, $U_{\min}$, γ , and q_{PAH} , the latter parameter being the PAH fraction. These three parameters are contained in the parameter set and are called `duste_umin`, `duste_gamma`, `duste_qpah`. The user can define each of these parameters in FSPS.

The THEMIS model has a similar setup to DL07 but with different underlying grain physics, and a wider allowed range in q_{PAH} and $U_{\min}$.

1.11 Circumstellar dust

Circumstellar dust around AGB stars is an option that can be included if the switch `add_agb_dust_model` is turned on, which it is by default. The circumstellar dust models are a grid of models derived from the radiative transfer code DUSTY, see Villaume et al. 2015 for details.

1.12 AGN dust

Dust emission associated with an AGN torus is an option that can be included if the switch `add_agn_dust` is turned on, which it is by default. In order for AGN dust to have an effect one must also set the `pset` parameter `fagn` to a non-zero value; by default this is set to 0.0. The AGN dust model is from Nenkova et al. (2008). Note that the models available within FSPS are a very small subset of the grids provided by Nenkova et al.; i.e., aside from the overall amplitude, the only other free parameter is the V -band optical depth of individual clouds.

1.13 Nebular emission

Nebular continuum and line emission is included within FSPS based on Cloudy tables provided by Nell Byler. The details of these grids are presented in Byler et al. (2017). This feature is off by default (for reasons of speed), and the relevant switch is `add_neb_emission`. One can also selectively turn off the continuum emission, choose between Cloudy tables that do or do not include dust, and can vary the gas-phase metallicity and ionization parameter.

1.14 Bursts of star formation

At present the user is able to specify a single burst time and burst strength. In the future it will be possible to specify multiple bursts. Note that while the bursts are added into the spectrophotometric outputs, they are *not* included in the output SFR columns. It is up to the user to add in these components by hand to the resulting effective SFR.

1.15 Output quantities

The basic executable routines available in the public distribution of FSPS outputs two files containing magnitudes and spectra. FSPS can also output two other files: color magnitude diagrams in all available filters and spectral indices in the Lick system with several additional indices. In order to output these files the user must modify the syntax calling `compsp` (specifically the `writecompsp` variable).

1.16 BPASS models

BPASS stellar population models are included in FSPS. These are binary stellar evolution models (v2.2; Eldridge, Stanway et al. 2017) that are made available as SSP SEDs for a variety of ages, metallicities, and IMFs. For this reason the BPASS models are handled differently than the other isochrone models in FSPS. Specifically, because the models are tabulated directly as SSPs, the user cannot modify the spectral library nor the adopted IMF. The BPASS models we have made available within FSPS are the “bin-imf135all_100” models, i.e., they assume a Salpeter IMF with an upper mass cutoff of $100M_{\odot}$. We have not included the very lowest metallicity model and have cut off the age grid at 15.8 Gyr.

1.17 General program advice

The code provided in this package is optimally designed to be integrated into a larger fortran program. The code reads all of the libraries into memory and then utilizes various routines to compute SSPs and CSPs. The benefit of the structure of this package is that it allows the user to produce very large numbers of models relatively quickly (e.g., $\sim 10^5$ models in 30 minutes on a 2.66 GHz Intel processor). It also allows one to easily integrate SPS into particular science tasks.

For those more interested in generating quick results, rather than using the more flexible aspects of the code, we also provide a routine that generates results after prompting the user for input. This program is called `autosps.exe`. Note that all outputs are placed in the `OUTPUTS` directory, included in the tarball, by default.

There is a well-maintained set of Python interfaces to FSPS, originally created by Dan Foreman-Mackey and now maintained by Ben Johnson, available here: <https://github.com/dfm/python-fsps>.

2. Details of Fortran Routines

2.1 The `sps_vars.f90` Module: Common Variables, Parameters, and Structure Set-up

It is recommended that the user read through the `sps_vars.f90` module. This module must be called at the beginning of every program that uses the routines described below. It sets up two types of variables: common and parameters. Both parameters and common variables can be seen by all routines and thus do not have to be explicitly passed during a call to a routine. The difference between the two is that the parameters are defined once in `sps_vars.f90` and thereafter cannot be changed. The common variables, by contrast, can be changed by various routines (see § 3.1.1). Be careful when changing common variables! The variables in this module are well-documented. Most parameters should not be changed.

The `sps_vars.f90` module also sets up structures (for those who are not familiar with fortran structures, they are similar in many ways to structures in IDL). There are two main structures that are used extensively in many routines. One of these is defined to conveniently handle the output of the `compsp.f90` routine; it should not be of much concern for most users. The second structure defines the parameter set. It is sufficiently important to warrant a more detailed discussion (see § 3.1.2).

2.1.1 Defining the isochrones, stellar libraries, and dust emission model

At the top of the `sps_vars.f90` module there are lines that start with `#define`. These lines set switches that tell the code to compile certain portions of the module depending on which switches are set. The switches are binary, with ‘1’=on and ‘0’=off. So for example in the standard release of `sps_vars.f90` you will see:

```
#define MILES 0
#define C3K_LR 1
```

```
#define C3K_HR 0

#define PADOVA 0
#define MIST 1
#define PARSEC 0
#define BASTI 0
#define GENEVA 0
#define BPASS 0

#define DL07 1
#define THEMIS 0
```

which tells the code to use the C3K low resolution stellar library, the MIST isochrones, and the DL07 dust emission model. *It is very important that you ‘make clean’ every time you change one of these switches.*

Additionally, when using the MIST isochrones and the C3K stellar libraries, it is possible to use α -enhanced isochrones and stellar libraries (e.g. Park et al. 2025). This is done by setting

```
#define AFE_FLAG 1
```

Users are encouraged to contact the developers regarding the use of this flag, as it can become memory intensive and requires specialized spectral libraries. See Park et al. (2025) for more details.

2.1.2 Common variables & parameters

We briefly describe several of the most important and most used common variables and parameters. These parameters are defined in `sps_vars.f90`.

- `add_agb_dust_model` Parameter to turn on/off the AGB circumstellar dust emission model presented in Villaume et al. (2014). By default this function is turned on as of v2.5.
- `add_dust_emission` Parameter to turn on/off the dust emission model. *Default is on.*
- `add_agn_dust` Parameter to turn on/off the AGN dust emission model of Nenkova et al. (2008).
- `add_igm_absorption` Parameter to turn on/off IGM absorption according to Madau (1995). By default this option is turned off.
- `add_neb_emission` Parameter to turn on/off the nebular emission model (both continuum and line emission), based on Cloudy models from Nell Byler. By default this option is turned *off*.
- `add_neb_continuum` Parameter to turn on/off the nebular continuum. By default this option is turned on. `add_neb_emission` must be turned on for this option to have any effect.
- `neblineinspec` Parameter to turn on/off the inclusion of nebular lines in the spectrum. `add_neb_emission` must be turned on for this option to have any effect. *Default is on.*
- `add_stellar_remnants` Parameter to turn on/off the inclusion of stellar remnants in the calculation of stellar masses. *Default is on.*
- `compute_vega_mags` A switch that sets the zero points of the magnitude system:
 - **0**: AB system
 - **1**: Vega system

Default is 0.

- **compute_light_ages** A switch that changes the output ages of COMPSP (see below) to bolometric luminosity weighted ages.
- **dust_type** Common variable defining the attenuation curve for the diffuse dust component:
 - **0**: power-law; see variable **dust_index** below.
 - **1**: Milky Way extinction law parameterized by Cardelli et al. (1989), with variable UV bump strength; see variables **mwr** and **uvb** below.
 - **2**: Calzetti et al. (2000) attenuation curve. Note that if this option is set then the dust attenuation is applied to all starlight equally (not split by age), and therefore the only relevant parameter is **dust2** (defined below), which sets the overall normalization (you must set **dust1**= 0.0 for this to work correctly).
 - **3**: allows the user to access a variety of attenuation curve models from Witt & Gordon (2000). See the parameters **wgp1**, **wgp2**, and **wgp3** in §3.1.2. In this case the parameters **dust1** and **dust2** have no effect because the WG00 models specify the full attenuation curve.
 - **4**: Kriek & Conroy (2013) attenuation curve. In this model the slope of the curve, set by the variable **dust_index**, is linked to the strength of the UV bump.
 - **5**: the SMC bar extinction curve from Gordon et al. (2003).
 - **6**: Reddy et al. (2015) attenuation curve.

Default is 0.

- **imf_type** Common variable defining the IMF type:
 - **0**: Salpeter (1955)
 - **1**: Chabrier (2003)
 - **2**: Kroupa (2001)
 - **3**: van Dokkum (2008)
 - **4**: Dave (2008)
 - **5**: tabulated piece-wise power-law IMF, specified in **imf.dat** file located in the **data** directory (or specified via the parameter **imf_filename**; see below).

Default is 2.

- **redshift_colors**
 - **0**: Magnitudes are computed at a fixed redshift specified in the parameter set (see below)
 - **1**: Magnitudes are computed at a redshift that corresponds to the age of the output SSP/CSP (assuming a redshift–age relation appropriate for a WMAP7 cosmology). This switch is useful if the user wants to compute the evolution in *observed* colors of a SSP/CSP.
- **smooth_velocity** Switch to smooth the spectrum in velocity space. If off, the spectrum is smoothed in wavelength space. The degree of smoothing is determined by the variable **sigma_smooth** in the parameter set (see below).
- **smooth_lsf** Parameter to smooth the SSPs by a tabulated instrumental LSF provided in **data/lsf.dat**. The assumed units are km/s (sigma, not FWHM). Turned off by default.
- **tpagb_norm_type** Parameter to choose the normalization of the TP-AGB stars (only applies to the Padova isochrones; default is 2):
 - **0**: Original normalization of the Padova isochrones

- **1:** Normalization from Conroy & Gunn (2010)
 - **2:** Normalization from Villaume et al. (2015)
- **time_res_incr** Parameter setting the factor by which the resolution of the default isochrone age array is increased. Default value is 1, which is sufficient for most purposes.
- **vactoir_flag** Parameter to write wavelengths in air rather than vacuum if set to 1. The default is to write wavelengths in vacuum.
- **verbose** Parameter that controls output to screen. If set to 1 a lot of output will be printed to screen, if set to 0 the programs will be silent.

2.1.3 The Parameter Set

The parameter set is a structure defined in the `sps_vars.f90` module. It must be defined at the beginning of every program for the various routines to properly work. This structure acts as the primary interface between what the user would like to compute and the various subroutines that actually do the work. Simply defining the structure at the beginning of the program will set all structure elements to their default values (see the example program `simple.f90`). The elements of the structure, and the default values, are described below. The parameters are organized by topic, e.g., star formation history, IMF, dust, and stellar evolution parameters.

Basic Parameters

- **zred** Redshift. If this value is non-zero and if `redshift_colors= 0`, the magnitudes will be computed for the spectrum placed at redshift **zred**. *Default value is 0.0.*
- **zmet** Metallicity index. The metallicity is specified as an integer ranging between 1 and NZ for the isochrones. A lookup table for the actual metallicities corresponding to the integer values is provided at the end of this manual. Note that $Z_{\odot} = 0.0190$. *Default value is 1.*
- **afeindx** Alpha-enhancement index. The α enhancement is specified as an integer ranging between 1 and N_AFE for the isochrones. This can only be changed if the isochrones and stellar libraries are α -enhanced (see §2.1.1). *Default value is 1.*
- **imf1** Logarithmic slope of the IMF over the range $0.08 < M < 0.5 M_{\odot}$. Only used if `imf_type= 2`. *Default value is 1.3.*
- **imf2** Logarithmic slope of the IMF over the range $0.5 < M < 1.0 M_{\odot}$. Only used if `imf_type= 2`. *Default value is 2.3.*
- **imf3** Logarithmic slope of the IMF over the range $1.0 < M < 100 M_{\odot}$. Only used if `imf_type= 2`. *Default value is 2.3.*
- **vdmc** IMF parameter defined in van Dokkum 2008. Only used if `imf_type= 3`. *Default value is 0.08.*
- **mdave** IMF parameter defined in Dave 2008. Only used if `imf_type= 4`. *Default value is 0.5.*
- **evtype** Only include isochrone points at a particular evolutionary phase specified in the isochrone table (see `data/ev_phases.tex` for phase options). Only available with for isochrones with phase information. All phases used when set to -1. *Default value is -1.*
- **masscut** Only include masses below **masscut** in the synthesis. *Default value is 150.0.*
- **imf_filename** Filename of the tabulated IMF file located in the `data` directory. If unset, the default `imf.dat` is assumed. Only applies if `imf_type= 5`.
- **mag_compute** Integer array of length **nbands**. Allows the user to choose which magnitudes are computed from the filter list. 1=yes, 0=no. All magnitudes are still printed to the mag file, but if the particular band has a value of 0 in this array, the output value will be 99. *Default values are 1 for all bands.*
- **sigma_smooth** Broadening of the spectrum, in units of km s^{-1} (if `smooth_velocity= 1`) or $\text{\AA}$, (if `smooth_velocity= 0`). This specifies the width of the Gaussian in terms of σ , not FWHM. *Default value is 0.0.*
- **min_wave_smooth** Minimum wavelength, in $\text{\AA}$, that will be smoothed if `sigma_smooth> 0`. *Default value is 1000 $\text{\AA}$.*
- **max_wave_smooth** Maximum wavelength, in $\text{\AA}$, that will be smoothed if `sigma_smooth> 0`. *Default value is 10,000 $\text{\AA}$.*

- **gas_logu** Value of the gas ionization parameter, U ; relevant only for the nebular emission model. *Default value is -2.0.*
- **gas_logz** Value of the gas metallicity; relevant only for the nebular emission model. *Default value is 0.0.*
- **igm_factor** Factor by which to multiply the default IGM absorption optical depth. *Default value is 1.0.*

SFH Parameters

- **sfh** Defines the type of star formation history, normalized such that one solar mass of stars is formed over the full SFH (except for tabular). *Default value is 0.*
 - **0:** SSP
 - **1:** A six parameter SFH (tau model plus a constant component and a burst), with parameters **tau**, **const**, **sf_start**, **sf_trunc**, **tburst**, and **fburst** (see below).
 - **2:** Tabulated SFH defined in a file called **sfh.dat** that must reside in the **data** directory (or a file specified via the parameter **sfh_filename**; see below). The file must contain three columns. The first column is time since the Big Bang in Gyr, the second is the SFR in units of solar masses per year, the third is the absolute metallicity. An example is provided in the **data** directory. The time grid in this file can be arbitrary (so long as the units are correct), but it is up to the user to ensure that the tabulated sfh is well-sampled so that the outputs are stable. Obviously, highly oscillatory data require dense sampling.
 - **3:** Reserved for special use of the tabulated SFH option. Allows the user to read in the tabulated SFHs directly into the necessary arrays, bypassing the need to create **sfh.dat** files. Email cconroy@cfa.harvard.edu if you would like further instructions for how to use this option.
 - **4:** This is the same as option 1 except that the tau-model component is replaced with a delayed tau model of the form $t e^{-t/\tau}$.
 - **5:** Delayed tau model with a transition at a time **sf_trunc** to a linearly decreasing SFH with the slope specified by **sf_slope**. See Simha et al. 2014 for details.
- **tau** Defines e-folding time for the SFH, in Gyr. Only used if **sfh**= 1 or 4. The range is $0.1 < \tau < 10^2$. *Default value is 1.0.*
- **const** Defines the constant component of the SFH. This quantity is defined as the fraction of mass formed in a constant mode of SF; the range is therefore $0 \leq C \leq 1$. Only used if **sfh**= 1 or 4. *Default value is 0.0.*
- **sf_start** Start time of the SFH, in Gyr. *Default value is 0.0.*
- **sf_trunc** Truncation time of the SFH, in Gyr. If set to 0.0, there is no truncation. *Default value is 0.0.*
- **tage** If set to a non-zero value, the **compsp** routine will compute the spectra and magnitudes only at this age, and will therefore only output one age result. The units are Gyr. (The default is for **compsp** to compute and return results from $t \approx 0$ to the maximum age in the isochrones). *Default value is 0.0.*
- **fburst** Defines the fraction of mass formed in an instantaneous burst of star formation. Only used if **sfh**= 1 or 4. *Default value is 0.0.*
- **tburst** Defines the age of the Universe when the burst occurs, in Gyr. If **tburst**>**tage** then there is no burst. Only used if **sfh**= 1 or 4. *Default value is 11.0.*
- **sf_slope** For **sfh**= 5, this is the slope of the SFR after time **sf_trunc**. *Default value is 0.0.*

- **sfh_filename** Filename of the tabulated SFH file located in the **data** directory. If unset, the default **sfh.dat** is assumed. Only applies if **sfh=2**.

Dust Parameters

- **dust_tesc** Stars younger than **dust_tesc** are attenuated by both **dust1** and **dust2**, while stars older are attenuated by **dust2** only. Units are log(yrs). *Default value is 7.0.*
- **dust1** Dust parameter describing the attenuation of young stellar light, i.e. where $t \leq \text{dust_tesc}$ (for details, see Conroy et al. 2009a). Specifically, it is the opacity at 5500Å. *Default value is 0.0.*
- **dust2** Dust parameter describing the attenuation of all stellar light. Specifically, it is the opacity at 5500Å. *Default value is 0.0.*
- **dust3** Optical depth of dust affecting only old stellar light, i.e. where $t > \text{dust_tesc}$ *Default value is 0.0.*
- **frac_nodust** Fraction of starlight that is not attenuated by the diffuse dust component (i.e. that is not affected by **dust2**). *Default value is 0.0.*
- **frac_obraun** Fraction of starlight that is not attenuated by the birth cloud dust component (i.e. that is not affected by **dust1**). *Default value is 0.0.*
- **dust_index** Power-law index of the diffuse dust attenuation curve. Only used when **dust_type=0** or **4**. *Default value is -0.7.*
- **dust1_index** Power-law index of the birth cloud dust attenuation curve. Used for all dust types. *Default value is -1.0.*
- **mwr** The ratio of total to selective absorption which characterizes the MW extinction curve: $R \equiv A_V/E(B-V)$. Only used when **dust_type=1**. *Default value is 3.1.*
- **uvb** Parameter characterizing the strength of the 2175Å extinction feature with respect to the standard Cardelli et al. determination for the MW. Only used when **dust_type=1**. *Default value is 1.0.*
- **wgp1** Integer specifying the optical depth in the Witt & Gordon 2000 (WG00) models. Values range from 1 – 18, corresponding to optical depths of 0.25, 0.50, 0.75, 1.00, 1.50, 2.00, 2.50, 3.00, 3.50, 4.00, 4.50, 5.00, 5.50, 6.00, 7.00, 8.00, 9.00, 10.0. Note that these optical depths are defined differently from the optical depths defined by the parameters **dust1** and **dust2**. See WG00 for details.
- **wgp2** Integer specifying the type of large-scale geometry and extinction curve. Values range from 1 – 6, corresponding to MW+dusty, MW+shell, MW+cloudy, SMC+dusty, SMC+shell, SMC+cloudy. MW= Milky Way extinction; SMC= Small Magellanic Cloud extinction. Dusty, shell, and cloudy specify the geometry and are described in WG00.
- **wgp3** Integer specifying the local geometry for the WG00 dust models. A value of 1 corresponds to a homogeneous distribution, and a value of 2 corresponds to a clumpy distribution. See WG00 for details.
- **duste_gamma** Parameter of the dust emission model. Specifies the relative contribution of dust heated at a radiation field strength of $U_{\min}$ and dust heated at $U_{\min} < U \leq U_{\max}$. Allowable range is 0.0 – 1.0. *Default value is 0.01.*
- **duste_umin** Parameter of the dust emission model. Specifies the minimum radiation field strength in units of the MW value. Valid range is between 0.1 and 25.0. *Default value is 1.0.*

- **duste_qpah** Parameter of the dust emission model. Specifies the grain size distribution through the fraction of grain mass in PAHs. This parameter has units of % and a valid range of 0.47–4.58. *Default value is 3.5.*
- **fagn** This parameter is the luminosity of the AGN expressed as a fraction of the stellar bolometric luminosity. *Default value is 0.0.*
- **agn_tau** V–band optical depth of individual clouds in the AGN model of Nenkova et al. (2008). *Default value is 10.0.*

Isochrone Parameters

- **redgb** Modify weight given to the RGB. Only available for isochrone sets that specify this phase (e.g., BaSTI). *Default value is 1.0.*
- **agb** Modify weight given to the AGB. Only available for isochrone sets that specify this phase (e.g., BaSTI). *Default value is 1.0.*
- **dell** Shift in $\log(L_{\text{bol}})$ of the TP-AGB isochrones. Note that the meaning of this parameter and the one below has changed to reflect the updated calibrations presented in Conroy & Gunn (2009). That is, these parameters now refer to a modification about the calibrations presented in that paper. *Default value is 0.0.*
- **delt** Shift in $\log(T_{\text{eff}})$ of the TP-AGB isochrones for Padova models. *Default value is 0.0.*
- **agb_dust** Scales the AGB circumstellar dust emission model presented in Villaume et al. (2014). *Default value is 1.0.*
- **fcstar** Currently has no effect. Previously, the fraction of stars that the Padova isochrones identify as Carbon stars that FSPS assigns to a Carbon star spectrum. Set this to 0.0 if for example the users wishes to turn all Carbon stars into regular M-type stars. Valid range is 0.0–1.0. *Default value is 1.0.*
- **sbss** Specific frequency of blue straggler stars. See Conroy et al. (2009) for details and a plausible range. *Default value is 0.0.*
- **fbhb** Fraction of horizontal branch stars that are blue. The blue HB stars are uniformly spread in $\log(T_{\text{eff}})$ to 10^4 K. See Conroy et al. 2009a for details and a plausible range. *Default value is 0.0.*
- **pagb** Weight given to the post–AGB phase. A value of 0.0 turns off post–AGB stars; a value of 1.0 implies that the Vassiliadis & Wood 1994 tracks are implemented as–is. *Default value is 1.0.*

2.2 Description of Fortran Routines

We now discuss the purpose and syntax of the routines in this package. §3.2.1 discusses the example routines provided in FSPS that demonstrate how many of these routines are used. Routines included in the **src** directory that are *not* discussed below are meant to only be accessed through other routines.

- **COMPSP(write_compssp,nzin,outfile,mass_ssp,lbol_ssp,spec_ssp,pset,ocompssp)**

This routine takes as input **mass_ssp**, **lbol_ssp**, and **spec_ssp**, which are the outputs of the routine **ssp_gen.f90**. The user must also provide the parameter set **pset** and filename for output in **outfile**, if output is desired (a blank string may be specified if no output is desired). There are six possible outputs, specified by **write_compssp**: No output (0), output magnitudes (1), output spectra (2), output magnitudes and spectra (3), output spectral indices (4), output color-magnitude diagrams (5). The outputs are written to files with the output filename with “.mags”, “.spec”, “.indx”, or “.cmd” appended.

A variety of output from this routine is saved in the **ocompssp** variable, which must be a structure as defined in **sps_vars.f90**. Again, see the example routine below.

The **nzin** parameter sets the number of metallicity points passed. For standard, single metallicity calculations, set this value to one and simply pass the outputs from **ssp_gen.f90**. However, if one wants to

compute spectra for an evolving metallicity (i.e. when computing a tabulated SFH, the metallicity history may be specified), one needs to set this parameter to the number of metallicity elements available (in the default release this is 22). One then must take care to pass the metallicity-dependent `ssp_gen.f90` outputs. Currently the code only allows the specification of a metallicity history when passing tabulated SFH.

- `GETMAGS(zred,spec,mags)`

The input is the redshift `zred` and spectrum `spec`. The output is an array of magnitudes `mags` for the redshifted spectrum.

- `GETINDX(lambda,spec,indices)`

This routine computes the spectral indices for the input spectrum `spec` with corresponding wavelength array `lambda`, returning the indices in an array `indices`. The `indices` array must be defined with an array length specified by the variable `nindx`, which specifies the number of indices. The indices are defined in the file `allindices.dat` in the `data` directory.

- `PZ_CONVOL(pset,zave,spec_pz,lbol_pz,mass_pz)`

This routine convolves the full array of metallicity-dependent SSPs with a closed-box metallicity distribution function (MDF). The yield (`pset%pmetals`) is the only input. Outputs include the average metallicity (`zave`) and the spectra, `lbol`, and mass integrated over the MDF. The full metallicity-dependent SSPs must have been previously set up. An example of how to use this routine is provided in `lesssimple.f90`.

- `SFHSTAT(pos,model,ssfr6,ssfr7,ssfr8,ave_age)`

This routine returns basic statistics for a given star formation history. The inputs are the parameter set (`pos`) and a single element output from the `compsp` routine (`model`). The outputs are the specific SFR (SSFR), averaged over 10^6 , 10^7 , and 10^8 yrs (`ssfr6`, `ssfr7`, `ssfr8`), and the mass-weighted average stellar age (`ave_age`). An example of how to use this routine is provided in `simple.f90`.

- `SPS_SETUP(zin)`

This routine must be called at least once before running any routines. It reads in all of the isochrones and spectral libraries and stores them in a common block. If the user requires only one metallicity, then that metallicity can be specified as `zin`. The metallicity must be specified as an integer corresponding to the look-up table at the end of this manual. If the user wishes to read in all metallicities, then `zin` should be set to -1.

- `SSP_GEN(pset,mass_ssp,lbol_ssp,spec_ssp)`

This routine takes as input the parameter set, `pset`, and outputs the time-dependent mass, `mass_ssp`, bolometric luminosity, `lbol_ssp`, and spectrum, `spec_ssp`, of an SSP defined by the parameter set. Each of these input variables must be properly defined at the beginning of the main routine. See the example routines for guidance.

- `SMOOTHSPEC(lambda,spec,sigma,minl,maxl)`

This routine broadens the input spectrum `spec` with corresponding wavelength array `lambda` by a velocity dispersion `sigma` measured in km/s. Note that the velocity broadening is only approximate in that we are ignoring the variation in $d\lambda$ with λ within each integration step.

- `WRITE_ISOCHRONE(outfile,zz)`

This routine writes the isochrones for all ages at a single metallicity to a file with name **outfile**. The metallicity of the isochrone is specified via the variable **zz** in the internal integer metallicity units (see the Table at the end of this manual). At each age the isochrone is written for all of the magnitudes specified in the **FILTER_LIST** file.

2.2.1. Example Routines

The code package contains several routines that highlight many of the features of FSPS. The routine **simple.f90** demonstrates the basic syntax required to generate simple models. In addition, there is a less simple routine located in the **src** directory, called **lesssimple.f90**, that highlights some more advanced features of the code.

3. Description of IDL Routines

- **res = read_indx(file)**

This function takes as input an index file and reads it into a simple IDL structure. The index file must be created by the user (unlike the **.spec** and **.mags** files, which are automatically created in the **compsp** routine). The format is the age followed by all of the indices defined in the file **INDEX_LIST**.

- **res = read_mags(file)**

This function takes as input the magnitude file (***.mags**) produced by **compsp.f90**. The output is an IDL structure with elements including the some of the magnitudes listed in **FILTER_LIST** and computed by **compsp.f90**. Note that not all magnitudes computed and listed in the ***.mags** file are contained in the resulting structure. This routine can be trivially modified to include other/all of the magnitudes computed.

- **res = read_spec(file)**

This function takes as input the spectra file (***.spec**) produced by **compsp.f90**. The output is an IDL structure with elements including the time-dependent spectrum computed by **compsp.f90**.

- **res = read_cmd(file)**

This function takes as input the CMD file (***.cmd**) produced by **compsp.f90**. The output is an IDL structure with elements including the time-dependent spectrum computed by **compsp.f90**.

- **res = read_indx(file)**

This function takes as input the index file (***.indx**) produced by **compsp.f90**. The output is an IDL structure with elements including the time-dependent spectrum computed by **compsp.f90**.

- **res = read_fsps(file)**

This function takes as input *any* file produced by **compsp.f90**. The function determines which type of file was passed based on the filename (***.spec**, ***.mags**, etc).

4. How do I...

4.1 add additional filters?

Adding additional filters is straightforward. There are three things the user must do: 1) modify the **nbands** parameter in the **sps_vars.f90** routine; 2) add the filter to the **allfilters.dat** file located in the **data** directory. Follow the format: there must be a line starting with a **#** sign, followed by two columns, the first being the wavelength in angstroms, the second being the total throughput. The filter can be of any resolution, and need not be properly normalized. 3) The user would be wise to add details of the filter to the

`FILTER.LIST` file located in the `data` directory, although this is not, strictly speaking, necessary for proper functioning of the code.

We would appreciate it if the user would email us if they add a filter so that we can include this filter in later releases (thereby saving others the trouble of adding filters).

5. Acknowledgements

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Table 1 Lookup table of metallicity values depends on the isochrone set being used.

zmet	Z [$\log(Z/Z_{\odot})$] Padova	Z [$\log(Z/Z_{\odot})$] BaSTI	$\log(Z/Z_{\odot})$ MIST	Z [$\log(Z/Z_{\odot})$] Geneva	Z [$\log(Z/Z_{\odot})$] PARSEC	Z BPASS
1	0.0002 (-1.98)	0.0003 (-1.82)	-2.50	0.0010 (-1.30)	0.0001 (-2.18)	0.0001
2	0.0003 (-1.80)	0.0006 (-1.52)	-2.25	0.0040 (-0.70)	0.0002 (-1.88)	0.0010
3	0.0004 (-1.68)	0.0010 (-1.30)	-2.00	0.0080 (-0.40)	0.0005 (-1.48)	0.0020
4	0.0005 (-1.58)	0.0020 (-1.00)	-1.75	0.0200 (+0.00)	0.0010 (-1.18)	0.0030
5	0.0006 (-1.50)	0.0040 (-0.70)	-1.50	0.0400 (+0.30)	0.0020 (-0.88)	0.0040
6	0.0008 (-1.38)	0.0080 (-0.40)	-1.25		0.0040 (-0.58)	0.0060
7	0.0010 (-1.28)	0.0100 (-0.30)	-1.00		0.0060 (-0.40)	0.0080
8	0.0012 (-1.20)	0.0200 (+0.00)	-0.75		0.0080 (-0.28)	0.0100
9	0.0016 (-1.07)	0.0300 (+0.18)	-0.50		0.0100 (-0.18)	0.0140
10	0.0020 (-0.98)	0.0400 (+0.30)	-0.25		0.0140 (-0.04)	0.0200
11	0.0025 (-0.89)		+0.00		0.0170 (+0.05)	0.0300
12	0.0031 (-0.79)		+0.25		0.0200 (+0.12)	0.0400
13	0.0039 (-0.69)		+0.50		0.0300 (+0.30)	
14	0.0049 (-0.59)				0.0400 (+0.42)	
15	0.0061 (-0.49)				0.0600 (+0.60)	
16	0.0077 (-0.39)					
17	0.0096 (-0.30)					
18	0.0120 (-0.20)					
19	0.0150 (-0.10)					
20	0.0190 (+0.00)					
21	0.0240 (+0.10)					
22	0.0300 (+0.20)					

Note. — $Z_{\odot} = 0.0190$ for Padova, $Z_{\odot} = 0.0200$ for BaSTI and Geneva, $Z_{\odot} = 0.0191$ for MIST, $Z_{\odot} = 0.0152$ for PARSEC, and $Z_{\odot} = 0.020$ for BPASS.